115. Which radioactive pollutant has recently drawn the attention of the public, due to its occurrence in the building material ?

(a) Plutonium (b) Thorium
(c) Radon (d) Radium

Ans. (b) : Thorium (Th^{4+}) is a radioactive ion, which is used as nuclear fuel and discharged to the environment as wastewaters produced from the nuclear fuels.
Thorium has recently drawn the attention of the public due to its occurrence in the building material. Thorium powders or sponge are melted in electric arc furnaces or in vacuum induction furnaces.

116. Indian expertise was recently used in the archaeological restoration of the monuments at

(a) Jerusalem (b) Angkor Wat
(c) Rome (d) Yucatan

Ans. (b) : Indian expertise was recently used in the archaeological restoration of the monument of Angkor Wat.
Angkor, in Cambodia's northern province of Siem Reap, is one of the most important archaeological site of Southeast Asia. It extends over approximately 400 square km and consists of scores of temples, hydraulic structure as well as communication routes.

117. "The Uniting for Peace Resolution" adopted by the U.N. has

(a) enhanced the powers of the General Assembly in a comprehensive way
(b) reduced the powers of the General Assembly
(c) made no difference to the powers of the General Assembly
(d) empowered the General Assembly to act in specific situations in matters of peace and security

Ans. (d) : General Assembly resolution 377 (v) is known as the United for peace resolution. Adopted in 1950, the resolution resolves that the security council, because of lack of unanimity of the permanent members, fails to exercise its primary responsibility to act as required to maintain international peace and security, the General Assembly shall consider the matter immediately with the view to making recommendations to members in order to restore international peace and security.

118. According to the newly adopted Constitution of Russia, the Prime Minister is appointed by

(a) the State Duma, the Lower Chamber of the Federal Assembly
(b) the President, with the consent of the State Duma
(c) the President, with the consent of the Federal Council
(d) the Federal Council

Ans. (b) : According to the newly-adopted constitution of Russia, the Prime Minister is appointed by the President, with the consort of the state Duma.

MISCELLANEOUS

119. Which of the following statements about the Dunkel draft is/are correct ?

I. It is mandatory for the Government of India to accept all its proposals in all the sectors.
II. In the field of agriculture, the main proposal is to cut agricultural subsidies.
III. In the field of textiles, it reiterates the operation of the multi fibre agreement.
IV. The proposals have already been accepted by the Parliament.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below.

Codes :

(a) I only (b) I and II only
(c) I, II and IV only (d) III and IV only

Ans. (c) : The "Dunkel Draft" in December 1991 was an historic turning point in the negotiations. Mr Dunkel's deep understanding of the technical issues combined with his shrewd diplomacy transformed hundreds of thousands of pages of diverse, often conflicting, proposal into a manageable single document of some 500 pages, distilling the essence of the future WTO.
"Dunkel Draft" is mandatory for the government of India to accept all its proposal in all the sectors. In the field of agriculture, the main proposal of "Dunkel Draft" is to cut agricultural subsidies.

120. Examine the following statements:

I. Either A and B are of the same age or A is older then B.
II. Either C and Dare of the same age or D is older than C.
III. B is older than C.

Which one of the following conclusions can be drawn from the
above statements?

(a) A is older than B
(b) B and D are of the same age
(c) D is older than C
(d) A is older than C

Ans. (d) : We know that-
1. $A \geq B$
2. $D \geq C$
3. $B > C$
From 1 & 3
A is greater than B & B is greater than C
$\therefore$ A is also greater than C i.e. $A > C$

121. E.T.A. is a terrorist organization in

(a) Cyprus
(b) Sri Lanka
(c) Spain
(d) South Africa

Ans. (c) : Created in 1959 at the height of Francisco Franco's dictatorship, which repressed Basque culture and language, ETA is accused of killing more than 850 people in its fight for an independent Basque homeland in northern Spain and southwest France.

122. Nirmal Hriday, Sanjiwini and Saheli are

(a) organisations engaged in social work
(b) herbal medicines produced in India for hypertension, heart disturbances and neurological problems
(c) names of some savings schemes mooted by nationalised banks
(d) institutions set up by Jayaprakash Narayan for the rehabilitation of erstwhile dacoits

Ans. (a) : Nirmal Hriday, Sanjivini and Saheli are agaristations engaged in social work, which were started by Mother Teressa. These were social organization working for the various problems of women and their rights.

123. The latest regional economic block to be formed is

(a) ASEAN (b) COMECON
(c) APEC (d) NAFTA

Ans. (d) : The North American Free Trade Agreement (NAFTA), which was enacted in **1994** and created a free trade zone for Mexico, Canada and the United States, is the most important feature in the U.S.-Mexico bilateral commercial relationship.
NAFTA provides coverage to services except for aviation transport, maritime, and basic telecommunications.

124. Which one of the following statements regarding the "veto" power in the Security Council is correct according to the United Nations Charter?

(a) The decisions of the Security Council on all non-procedural matters must be made by an affirmative vote of nine members, including the concurring, votes of the permanent members of the Council.
(b) Every permanent member of the Security Council can prevent any decision from being accepted, by vetoing it.
(c) The term veto was used in Article 27 of the United Nations Charter to enable any permanent member of the Security Council to prevent any resolution from being passed by the majority.
(d) Any member of the Security Council can prevent any resolution from being passed by voting against it.

Ans. (b) : The veto power is probably the UN charter's most significant distinction between permanent and non-permanent members. Article 27(3) of the charter establishes that all substantive decisions of the council must be made with "the concurring votes of the permanent Members.
Permanent members use the veto to defend their national interests, to uphold a tenet of their foreign policy or, in some cases, to promote a single issue of particular importance to a state.
Since 16 February 1946, when the USSR cast the first veto on a draft resolution regarding the withdrawal of foreign troops form Lebanon and Syria. The veto has been recorded 293 times.

125. Who among the following became the Prime Minister of India without being earlier the Chief Minister of a State ?

I. Morarji Desai
II. Charan Singh
III. V. P. Singh
IV. Chandrashekhar
V. P.V. Narasimha Rao.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below.

Codes :

(a) I, II and IV (b) II, II and V
(c) II only (d) IV only

Ans. (d) : Shri Chandra Shekhar was born on 1st July, 1927, in a farmer's family in village Ibrahimpatti in District Ballia, Uttar Pradesh. He was president of the Janta Party 1977 to 1988. In 1988 Shekhar's Janta Party merged with several other opposition parties to form the Janta Dal Party under the leadership of V.P. Singh. He replaced V.P. Singh as India's Prime Minister on 10th November, 1990, as head of a weak minority government.

126. Which one of the following is a language of Baluchistan but linguistically Dravidian ?

(a) Brahui (b) Kui
(c) Parji (d) Pengo

Ans. (a) : Brahui is a northern Draviadian language spoken Primarily by the Brahvi people in the central part of Balochistan Province, in Pakistan and inscattered parts of Iran, Afghanistan and Turkmenistan and by expatriate Brahui communities in Iraq, Qatar and U.A.E. It is isolated from the neared Dravidian-speaking neighbor population of South India by a distance of more than 1,500 km.